

DANCE FESTIVAL

Time to Step Up

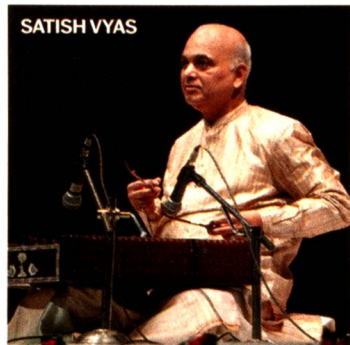
The *Natyashastra*, an almost 3,000-year-old manual on stagecraft, has been India's contribution to the world of performing arts. The manual, considered both a boon and a bane for Indian dancers trying to break free of the traditions imposed by the classical framework, continues to captivate generations of performers. While the classical dance forms find patrons and lobbies both in the government and from cultural impresarios, contemporary dance continues to be a neglected and fledgling genre. Bangalore-based Attakkalari, led by art director Jayachandran Palazhy, is probably

the only national platform for performers in this genre. The centre will be hosting Attakkalari Biennial 2009—a festival which will bring together thinkers, designers, performers, choreographers and scholars to discuss the future of contemporary dance in the country. It will feature some of the most acclaimed performances from within India and the world over. Besides the much awaited premiere of the centre's own production *Chronotopia*, acts to look forward to include *Murder in the Elevator* by Dance Theatre Cgado from South Korea, *Could I Draw Your Attention to the Brevity of Life?* by Cie Philippe Saire from Switzerland and *ETE* (Extended Teenage Era) by Samir Akika from Germany. Starting on February 7, at venues across Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran

CHRONOTOPIA
IS SET TO
PREMIERE AT
THE FESTIVAL

SATISH VYAS



VINOD SHARMA

MUSIC FESTIVAL

Voices of TRIBUTE

Greatness never dies. And great gurus live on through their music. Guru Pandit Jagannathbua Purohit is one such guru who is revered for his teachings. To pay a tribute to Purohit, the Maharashtra Lalit Kala Nidhi has organised a two-day Gunidas Sangeet Sammelan on February 7 and 8 at Kamani Auditorium in Delhi. The line-up is very different because it will feature a jugalbandi between two vocalists—Ashwini Bhide from the Jaipur Atrauli gharana and Sanjeev Abhayankar from the Mewati gharana. A string duet between Satish Vyas (santoor) and Kala Ramnath (violin) will also take place. Other artistes include Madhup Mudgal (vocal) and Purbayan Chatterjee (sitar). On February 12, Manjari Chaturvedi, creator of Sufi Kathak, will be dancing to the tunes of musicians from Iran and qawwals from Awadh at the Kamani Auditorium.

by S. Sahaya
Ranjit

MANJARI CHATURVEDI

